

Pratibha Devi Singh Patil (25 July 2007 to 25 July 2012) took oath as the 12<sup>th</sup> President of India on 25 July 2007. She was the first woman President of India. According to the tenure-order she was the 14<sup>th</sup> President of India.

**129. Who was the candidate of the United Progressive Alliance (UPA) in 15<sup>th</sup> Presidential Election in India?**

- (a) Yashwant Sinha (b) Shatrughan Sinha  
(c) Droupadi Murmu (d) Shankar Agarwal  
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

**67<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) (Re- Exam), 2021**

**Ans. (e)**

Meera Kumar was the candidate of the United Progressive Alliance in the 15th Presidential election in India so option (e) is correct. However, the former Jharkhand Governor Draupadi Murmu was the official candidate of the ruling National Democratic Alliance (NDA), while former Union Finance Minister Yashwant Sinha was the candidate supported by the opposition parties in the 16th Presidential election.

**130. Which one of the following President of India has been the Governor of Bihar?**

- (a) Dr. Rajendra Prasad (b) Dr. S.D. Sharma  
(c) Dr. Zakir Hussain (d) V.V. Giri

**U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2004**

**Ans. (c)**

Dr. Zakir Husain held the office of Governor (Bihar) from 6 July, 1957 to 11 May, 1962, Vice-President from **13 May, 1962 to 12 May, 1967** and the office of President from 13 May, 1967 to 3 May, 1969 (till death).

**131. Which of the following President was appeared before Supreme Court, when Supreme Court was hearing election dispute of the President?**

- (a) Dr. Zakir Hussain (b) V.V. Giri  
(c) Fakharuddin Ali Ahmad (d) Neelam Sanjiva Reddy  
(e) Gyani Zail Singh

**Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2016**

**Ans. (b)**

Former President V.V. Giri appeared in person before the Supreme Court as an incumbent President of India following a petition filed in the Supreme Court contesting the validity of election on the ground of having used corrupt practices to influence voters. The bench headed by Justice S.M. Sikri ultimately dismissed the petition and upheld Giri's election as President. Notably, V.V. Giri had got the majority on counting the second preference votes.

**132. Rashtrapati Bhavan was designed by:**

- (a) Edward Stone (b) Le Corbusier  
(c) Edwin Lutyens (d) Tarun Dutt

**U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2014**

**Ans. (c)**

Rashtrapati Bhavan is the official home of the President of India. It was designed by the British Architect Edwin Lutyens. It was known as Viceroy House till 1947. C. Rajgopalachari became the first Indian to reside in this 'Government House'. On 21 June, 1948. On 15 August, 1947, its name was changed to 'Government House'.

## The Vice-President

\*The post of the Vice-President of India is modelled on the lines of the American Vice-President. \*Vice-President is next to the President in the official order of precedence. \*According to Article 63, there shall be a Vice-President of India. \*According to **Article 64**, the Vice-President is the **ex-officio Chairman of the Council of States**. \*While acting as the President or discharging the functions of the President, the Vice-President does not perform the duties of the office of the chairman of Rajya Sabha (Article 65) and he is not entitled to the salary or allowance payable to the Chairman of Rajya Sabha but the salary and allowances of the President. \*He is elected by members of an electoral college consisting of the Members (**both elected and nominated**) of both houses of Parliament. \*According to **Article 66 (1)**, the election of Vice-President is held in accordance with the system of **proportional representation** by means of the single transferable vote and the voting is done by secret ballot. \*The eligibility for election as Vice-President (a citizen of India, should have completed 35 years of age, and should be qualified for election as a member of the Rajya Sabha) is mentioned in Article 66 (3). \*The Vice-President draws his salary (4 lakh per month) in his capacity as the ex-officio chairman of the Rajya Sabha. \*The constitution has not fixed any emoluments for the Vice-President in that capacity. \*According to **Article 67**, the Vice-President holds office for a term of five years. According to article 67(a), a vice president may, by writing under his hand addressed to the president, resign his office. \*According to **Article 67 (b)** he can be removed by a resolution of the Rajya Sabha passed by an absolute majority and agreed to by the Lok Sabha.

\*The Vice – President of India and their terms of office is as follows-

|     |                          |                 |
|-----|--------------------------|-----------------|
| 1.  | Dr. S. Radha Krishnan    | 1952-1962       |
| 2.  | Dr. Zakir Hussain        | 1962-1967       |
| 3.  | V.V. Giri                | 1967-1969       |
| 4.  | G.S. Pathak              | 1969-1974       |
| 5.  | B. D. Jatti              | 1974-1979       |
| 6.  | M. Hidaytullah (Justice) | 1979-1984       |
| 7.  | R. Venkataraman          | 1984-1987       |
| 8.  | Dr. Shankar Dayal Sharma | 1987-1992       |
| 9.  | K. R. Narayanan          | 1992-1997       |
| 10. | Dr. K.Krishnakant        | 1997-2002       |
| 11. | Bhairon Singh Shekhawat  | 2002-2007       |
| 12. | Mohd. Hamid Ansari       | 2007-2017       |
| 13. | Venkaiah Naidu           | 2017- 2022      |
| 14. | Jagdeep Dhankhar         | 2022- Incumbent |

1. The Vice-President of India is elected by the members of an electoral college comprising –

- Only elected members of both the Houses of Parliament.
- All the members of both the Houses of Parliament.
- Only elected members of Rajya Sabha and State Assemblies.
- Only elected members of State Assemblies.

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012

Ans. (b)

According to **Article 66(1)**, the Vice-President is elected by the members of an electoral college consisting of the members of both the Houses of Parliament in accordance with the system of proportional representation by means of the single transferable vote.

2. The Vice-President of India is elected by:

- The People
- The Electoral College which elects the President
- The members of both the Houses of Parliament
- The State Legislatures

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

3. How is Vice-President of India elected?

- By direct national election
- Nomination by President
- through direct election by the MPs of Lok Sabha and MLAs of Vidhan Sabha

(d) through election by the MPs of Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (d)

The Vice-President is elected by the members of an electoral college consisting of the members of both Houses (Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha) of Parliament [(Art. 66(1)].

4. Who amongst the following elects the Vice-President of India?

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- Member of Lok Sabha
- Members of Rajya Sabha
- Members of Legislative Assemblies
- Members of Legislative Councils

Code :

- 1 and 2 only
- 1 and 3 only
- 1, 2 and 3 only
- 1, 2, 3 and 4

U.P.P.C.S.(Pre) 2012

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

5. Electoral College for the 16<sup>th</sup> Vice Presidential Election of India for 2022 consists of how many members?

- 798
- 788
- 545
- 250
- None of the above/More than one of the above

67<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) (Re- Exam), 2022

Ans. (b)

As per Article 66 of the Constitution of India, the Vice-President is elected by the members of an electoral college. The Electoral College consists of Elected members of the Rajya Sabha, Nominated members of the Rajya Sabha and Elected members of the Lok Sabha. Members included in the Electoral College for the 16<sup>th</sup> Vice Presidential Election:

- 233 elected members of Rajya Sabha
- 12 nominated members of Rajya Sabha
- 543 elected members of the Lok Sabha
- The total number of members included in the electoral college formed by combining both the houses were 788.

6. Consider the following statements. Which of these statements is/are correct?

- Like the election of the President, the election of Vice-President is indirect.
- The Member of the State Legislatures play an important role in the election of the both.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

Code :

- 1 only
- 2 only

(c) 1 and 2 both

(d) Neither 1 nor 2

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (a)

According to Article 54, the President shall be elected by the members of an **electoral college** consisting of elected members of both Houses of Parliament and elected members of the Legislative Assemblies of the States. According to Article 66, the Vice-President shall be elected by the members of an electoral college consisting of the members of both Houses of Parliament in accordance with the system of Proportional representation by means of the single transferable vote and the voting at such election shall be by secret ballot. Thus, the President and Vice-President's election is held in accordance with the system of **Proportional representation** by means of the single transferable vote, and the voting is done by secret ballot, so statement 1 is correct while statement 2 is incorrect. Thus, option (a) is correct.

7. Given below are two statements, Assertion (A) and Reason (R).

**Assertion (A):** In order to be eligible for election as Vice-President, a person must be qualified for election as a member of the Upper House.

**Reason (R) :** Vice-President is chairperson of Rajya Sabha.

Which of the following is correct in regard to the above statements.

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is an acceptable explanation of (A).
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not an acceptable explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- (d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Spl) (Pre) 2010

Ans. (a)

**Article 66(3)** of the Constitution describes that a person is eligible for election as Vice-President if he is citizen of India, completed the age of 35 years and is qualified for election as a member of the Council of States and **Article 64** provides that Vice-President is ex-officio Chairman of the Council of States and shall not hold any other office of profit.

8. Consider the following statements about Vice-President of India.

- 1. He is an ex-officio Chairman of the Rajya Sabha.
- 2. He is elected by members of an electoral college consisting of members of both Houses of Parliament.

Which of the Statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 Only
- (b) 2 Only

(c) Both 1 and 2

(d) None of the above

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

According to the Article 64 (Indian Constitution), the Vice-President is the ex-officio chairman of the council of states (Rajya Sabha) Hence Statement 1 is correct.

According to Article 66(1), the Vice-president is elected by the members of an electoral college consisting of the members of both the houses of parliament in accordance with the system of proportional representation by means of single transferable vote.

Hence statement 2 is correct.

So, option (c) is correct answer.

9. Who is the Chairman of Rajya Sabha?

- (a) The President
- (b) The Vice-President
- (c) The Prime Minister
- (d) The Speaker of Lok Sabha

45<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (b)

Rajya Sabha is presided over by the Vice-President, but he is not a member of the Upper House.

10. Who is the Ex-Officio Chairman of the Rajya Sabha?

- (a) The President
- (b) The Vice President
- (c) The Prime Minister
- (d) None of the above
- (e) None of the above / more than one of the above

63<sup>rd</sup> B. P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

11. Which of the following statements is not correct?

- (a) To hold the office of President Candidate should have the minimum age of 35 years.
- (b) Vice-President is Chairman of Rajya Sabha
- (c) Vice-President is appointed by the President of India
- (d) First President of India was Dr. Rajendra Prasad.

38<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (c)

According to Article 66, the Vice-President is elected by the members of Parliament by the Proportional Representation System and Single Transferable Vote System. All the other three statements are true.

12. Which of the following statements about the Vice-President of India are not correct?

- 1. In order to be the Vice-President, a person must be qualified for election as a member of the House of the People.
- 2. A member of the State Legislature can be a candidate for this office.
- 3. The term of the Office of the Vice-President is the same as that of the President.

**4. He can be removed through a formal impeachment.**

**Select the correct answer using the code given below:**

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 3  
(c) 1 and 4 (d) 3 and 4

**U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005**

**Ans. (c)**

Statements 1 and 4 are wrong by virtue of Articles 66(3)(c) and 67(b). According to Article 67(b) of the Constitution, a Vice-President may be removed from his office by a resolution of the Council of States by a majority of all the then members of the Council and agreed to by the House of the People. No resolution for this purpose shall be moved unless at least 14 days prior notice has been given of the intention to move the resolution. According to Article 66(3)(c) to be eligible for election as Vice-President, a person must be qualified for election as a member of the Council of States.

**13. With reference of the election of the Vice-President of India, which is declared void by the Supreme Court of India, which of the following statement/s is/are correct?**

- (1) The acts done by him as Vice President before such declaration are considered valid.  
(2) The acts done by him as Vice-President on the day of such declaration are not considered valid.

**Select the correct answer from the code given below :  
Code :**

- (a) Both (1) and (2) (b) Only (1)  
(d) Neither (1) nor (2) (c) Only (2)

**U.P.P.C.S. (Pre.) 2023**

**Ans. (b)**

As per Article 71(2), if the election of a person as President or Vice president is declared void by the Supreme Court, acts done by him in the exercise and performance of the powers and duties of the office of President or Vice President, as the case may be, on or before the date of the decision of the Supreme Court shall not be invalidated by reason of that declaration. Thus, statement (1) is correct and statement (2) is incorrect. Hence, option (b) is correct answer.

**14. The Vice-President of India :**

1. Is the second highest dignitary of India.
2. Has no formal function attached to his office
3. Discharges the functions of the President during his absence.
4. Acts as the President if the President resigns, or is removed or dies.

**Select the correct answer from the code given below :  
Code :**

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 1,2 and 3  
(c) 1,3 and 4 (d) All the four

**U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2013**

**Ans. (d)**

The office of the Vice-President of India is the second-highest Constitutional Office of India after the President. Article 63 of the Indian Constitution says that there shall be a Vice-President of India. The Vice-President shall act as President during casual vacancies in the office of President by reason of death, resignation, impeachment or other situations.

**15. If Vice-President of India has to discharge the duties of President of India in his absence due to some reasons, then what is/are true for such duration?**

- (i) In this duration, Vice-President holds the post of Chairman of Council of States  
(ii) In this duration, Vice-President will get the emolument of President  
(iii) If in this duration, Vice-President resigns, then Chief Justice of India will perform the duties of President of India

- (a) (i), (ii) and (iii) (b) (i) and (ii)  
(c) (ii) and (iii) (d) Only (i)

**Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2021**

**Ans. (c)**

As per Article 64, if the Vice-President of India has to discharge the duties of the President of India in his absence due to some reasons, then, in this duration the Vice-President shall not perform the duties of the office of chairman of the council of states. In this duration, the Vice-President will get the emolument of the President (under Article 65(3)). As per the President (Discharge of functions) Act, 1969, if in this duration, Vice-President resigns, then the Chief Justice of India will perform duties of the President of India.

**16. The Vice-President may be removed from his office by a resolution of –**

- (a) Council of States (b) Lok Sabha  
(c) Cabinet (d) Council of Ministers

**U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013**

**Ans. (a)**

According to Article 67(b), the Vice-President may be removed from his office by a resolution of the Council of States (Rajya Sabha) passed by a majority of all the then members of the Council and agreed to by the House of the People; but no resolution shall be moved unless at least 14 days prior notice has been given of the intention to move the resolution.

**17. A resolution for the removal of the Vice-President of India can be proposed in –**

- (a) Lok Sabha only  
(b) Any House of Parliament  
(c) Joint Session of Parliament  
(d) Rajya Sabha only

**U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2003, 2004**

**U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007**

**Ans. (d)**

See the explanation of the above question.